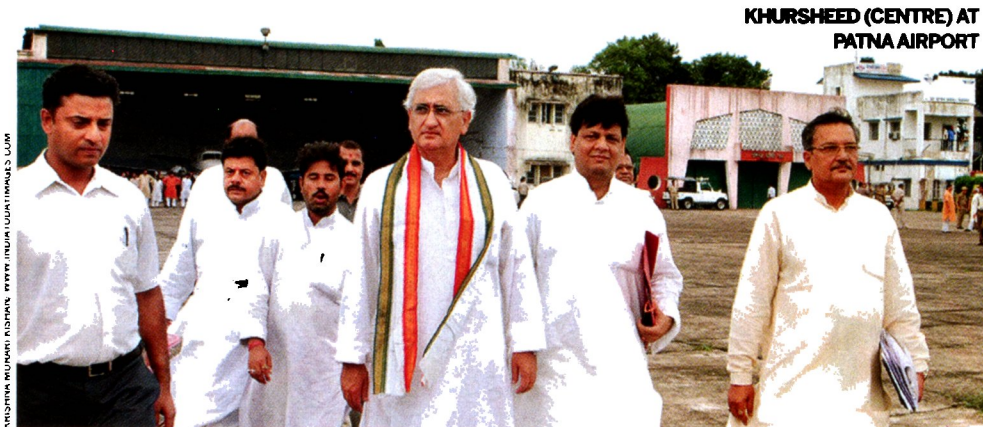


PATNA | Bypoll Bustle



KHURSHED (CENTRE) AT PATNA AIRPORT

On the eve of Bihar's Assembly bypolls for 18 seats, Congress leader Salman Khursheed's copter landed amid green flags at an election rally of RJD chief Lalu Prasad Yadav. Khursheed's chopper was greeted with lusty cheers of "Lalu zindabad" which soon turned into a mortified hush. He flew off before the

RJD men could berate him for hijacking the venue. This wasn't the only Bihar bypoll comedy of errors. Rivals Lalu and Sharad Yadav had been allotted the same venue at the same time by erring officials. Lalu and Ramvilas Paswan landed and launched their speeches only after Sharad had left. *by Amitabh Srivastava*

Self Help

The united deposition made to RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat by BJP's 'Advani faction' of Arun Jaitley, Sushma Swaraj, Venkaiah Naidu and Ananth Kumar went down like a dud bomb. The RSS doesn't like partymen (and women) canvassing for themselves.

DELHI | Games, Set and Mismatch

A stinging letter from Commonwealth Games Federation chief Mike Fennell turned the heat on the organisers of the 2010 Commonwealth Games (CWG). Fennell hollered for the prime minister, saying he is "extremely worried" about Delhi's capacity to host the Games "to any comparable standard". A cue, it would seem, to sound the alarm and hire a few dozen more overseas consultants to step into the breach. That would certainly make Fennell and Games CEO Mike Hooper happy. What will remain unresolved though, is the strongest undercurrent in the CWG organisation—the running feud between Games Organising Committee Chairman Suresh Kalmadi and Indian Olympic Association General Secretary

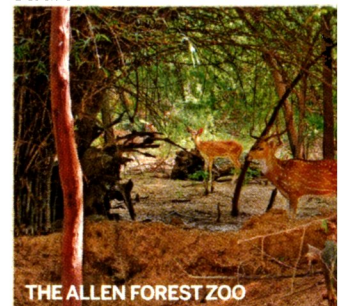


Randhir Singh. "This is their worst phase," said an insider. Those keeping score say Kalmadi has lost points with this episode but remains confident of a comeback. *by Sharda Ugra*

KANPUR | Deer Cause

The mysterious deaths of 14 deer in Kanpur's Allen Forests Zoo on September 12 was lost in Mayawati's latest statue-and-park drive. Even a missive from Union Minister for Forests and Environment Jairam Ramesh failed to evoke a response from the chief minister's office. Ramesh had written to Mayawati drawing attention towards the shortage of technical and scientific staff at the zoo much before the deer

LALU CHAUHAN



THE ALLEN FOREST ZOO

tragedy. Mayawati's office ignored Ramesh's letter. With the deer deaths inching towards centrestage, the Forest Department has suspended seven junior officials. The Supreme Court has expressed concern over the mindless deforestation and deteriorating environmental conditions in the state. To shake off this image, Uttar Pradesh will set up three more zoos to add to its tally of 11. One is slated for Gorakhpur from where state Forest Minister Fateh Bahadur Singh is